Zexing (Alfred) Zhao

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Education

Georgia Institute of Technology Atlanta, GA, USA
Computational Science and Engineering (Home Unit: Mechanical Engineering), M.S. Aug. 2026 (Incoming)
Northwest A&F University(NWAFU, Project 985,211) Yangling, China
Agricultural Mechanization and Automation, BEng, GPA:3.48, Rank: 2/80 Sep. 2019 – Jun. 2023
Software Engineering, BEng Sep. 2023 – Jun. 2025

Research Interests

AI for Science: Physics Informed Learning, Computational Physics, Scientific Machine Learning
Embodied Intelligence: World Models, Multimodal Perception, Sim-to-Real Transfer

Publications & Manuscripts

• **Accepted: Zexing Zhao**, Guangsi Shi, et al. Graph Navier-Stokes Neural Networks. *ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD), 2026.*

• **Published: Zexing Zhao**, Guangsi Shi, et al. DIG-Mol: A Contrastive Dual-Interaction Graph Neural Network for Molecular Property Prediction. *IEEE Journal of Biomedical and Health Informatics*, 2024.

• **Published:** Hongye Cheng, Tianyu Wang, Guangsi Shi, **Zexing Zhao**, et al. HOP: Heterogeneous Topology-based Multimodal Entanglement for Co-Speech Gesture Generation. *CVPR*, 2025.

• **Published:** Xiaopeng Wu, Guangsi Shi, **Zexing Zhao**, et al. DCCN: A Dual-Cross Contrastive Neural Network for 3D Point Cloud Representation Learning. *Expert Systems with Applications*, 2024.

• **Manuscript:** Evolutionary Tree Generation from Taxonomy-Aware Citation Graphs. *First author*, manuscript in preparation for submission to *ACL EMNLP 2026*.

• **Manuscript:** Multimodal Representation Learning for Human Gesture Generation. *First author*, manuscript in preparation for submission to *IEEE TPAMI*.

• **Patent: Zexing Zhao**, Shunan Liu, Weijie Miao, et al. (2021). A material gripping device for UAV.

• **Patent:** Binghui Ye, **Zexing Zhao**, Yuancheng Xu, et al. (2021). A contest robot for water saving irrigation.

Skills & Related Courses

Programming languages: Python, R, C, MATLAB

Tools: GitHub, LaTeX, Linux, VS Code, AutoCAD, SolidWorks, ANSYS, COMSOL, Fluent, SQL

Related Courses : Calculus, Linear Algebra, Probability Theory, Machine Learning, Organic Chemistry, Bioinformatics, Molecular Biology, Atomic Physics and Quantum Mechanics, Theoretical Mechanics, Mechanics of Material, Hydromechanics, Fundamentals of Heat Engineering, Experimental Design

Selected Research Projects

Evolutionary Tree Generation from Taxonomy-Aware Citation Graphs
| *Graph Data Mining, Knowledge Evolution* Jun. 2025 – Present
Supervised by Prof. Liang Zhao, Emory University, Atlanta
- Developing graph-based methods for evolutionary tree generation from citation graphs, effectively modeling the evolution and development of research fields by capturing hierarchical structures and temporal dynamics of research works. (This work may be the first attempt in this emerging research direction.)

Multimodal Representation Learning for Human Gesture Generation
| *Multimodal Learning, Embodied AI* Jun. 2025 – Present
Collaborated with Dr. Guangsi Shi, Midea Corporate Research Center, Shanghai
- Designing a multimodal learning framework that fuses text, audio, and motion signals into unified entangled representations, enabling virtual human skeleton generation synchronized with audio and exhibits natural realism.

Multi-Source Feature Learning for Predicting Disordered Protein Binding Modes
| *AI4Science, Protein Engineering* Feb. 2025 – Jun. 2025
Undergraduate Thesis |Supervised by Dr. Fuhao Zhang
- Integrated protein physicochemical properties with embeddings from protein language models (pLMs) to build hybrid representations, improving prediction of intrinsically disordered protein binding modes.
- Proposed a two-stage model that separately predicts disordered regions and binding modes, mitigating class imbalance and enhancing interpretability.

Graph Navier-Stokes Neural Networks

| *Graph Neural Networks, Physics Informed Learning* Feb. 2024 – Feb. 2025

Collaborated with Dr. Guangsi Shi, Midea Corporate Research Center, Shanghai

- Reformulated GNN message passing through the lens of the Navier-Stokes equations, decomposing it into a convection term for directed message transport and a diffusion term for local feature consistency, fundamentally mitigating the over-smoothing problem.
- Introduced the formal definition of a node-level velocity field on graphs, where node velocities govern the strength and direction of convective message passing, enabling adaptive, anisotropic information flow
- Derived and empirically validated a trade-off law between graph homophily ratio and node velocity, providing principled guidance for adapting GNN message passing across both homophilic and heterophilic graphs.
- Achieved 7% average improvement on 11 out of 12 public benchmarks; accepted as first-author paper at KDD 2026 (see Publications).

Molecular Proporty Prediction Based on Graph Contrastive Learning

| *AI4Science, Drug Discovery* Oct. 2022 – Dec. 2023

Collaborated with Dr.Guangsi Shi, Monash University, Australia

- Developed a novel graph contrastive learning framework for self-supervised learning on large-scale unlabeled datasets, outperforming most state-of-the-art baselines.
- Incorporated a dual-interaction framework and momentum distillation mechanism to extract effective representations from complex molecular graphs, significantly enhancing model performance.
- Implemented an advanced molecular graph augmentation strategy that preserves molecular structure.

Design of Agriculture Q&A System Based on Knowledge Graph

| *Knowledge Graph, Natural Language Processing* Dec. 2022 – Jun. 2023

Undergraduate Thesis | Supervised by Dr. Guangsi Shi , Monash University, Australia

- Developed a knowledge graph-based Q&A system for crop disease inquiries, achieving over 65% accuracy.
- Crawled web data and used a BERT-BiLSTM-CRF model to extract and store entities and relationships in Neo4j.
- Utilized the trained model to identify entities and relations in queries, linking them to the KG for answers.

Leadership Experiences & Activities

Small Animal Protection Association, NWAFU | *Member* 2019 – 2025

- Provided 'Trap Neuter Release' services to manage stray animal populations on campus.
- Rehabilitated and rehomed vulnerable animals, ensuring their safe transition into permanent homes.

Intelligent Agriculture Equipment Association, NWAFU | *Student president* Jun. 2021 – Nov. 2021

- Led day-to-day operations of the association, ensuring smooth functioning and sustainable growth.
- Organized academic competition teams, overseeing preparation and participation.

Community COVID-19 Prevention and Control Volunteer Organization | *Volunteer* Oct. 2021

- Disseminated health guidelines and COVID-19 prevention measures to local residents.
- Distributed protective supplies including masks and disinfectants to households.

Honors & Awards

- Merit Graduate in NWAFU Jun. 2023
- Merit Student in NWAFU 2022
- First-class scholarship 2022
- Merit camper in summer camp of Xi'an Jiaotong University, School of Mechanical Engineering Jul. 2022
- Third-class scholarship 2020, 2021
- Provincial second prize of 15th Digital-Design-Dimensions Show | *Key member* Mar. 2023
- National first prize of 7th International College Students Intelligent Agricultural Equipment Innovation Competition | *Team leader* Jun. 2022
- National second prize of 23rd China Robot and Artificial Intelligence Competition | *Key member* Nov. 2021
- Provincial first prize of 23rd China Robot and Artificial Intelligence Competition | *Key member* Jun. 2021

Hobbies

Basketball, Jigging, Fishing, Hiking, Gunpla